Aligning Training and Evaluation Formats

Experiment index

Question and Context

Was a training/evaluation format mismatch preventing the model from using clarification and refusal?

Generic examples taught a plain request plus tools. BAYMAX evaluation supplied a structured request with current_time, initial_state and request, and injected two meta-tools. Those are meaningfully different input distributions.

Change

Align the structured wrapper, shared meta-tool definitions, names, ordering and system-prompt expectations between training and local evaluation. Non-ACT targets remain actual JSON calls, not prose-only answers.

This checkpoint became the historical "aligned" reference. It is different from the later target-compatible anchored two-epoch reference.

Results

Evaluation	Cases	Task success	Tool accuracy	Argument accuracy	Clarification wording	Refusal wording
Format-aligned	50	14/50 (0.280)	0.580	0.853	0.056	0.071
Format-aligned / historical settings	150	42/150 (0.280)	0.473	0.771	0.083	0.019
Format-aligned / matched training prompt	150	40/150 (0.267)	0.453	0.771	0.025	0.017
Format-aligned	30	5/30 (0.167)	0.517	0.817	0.100	0.100

Values are ratios from 0 to 1, rounded to three decimals. Clarification/refusal columns measure wording criteria, not routing alone. Different suite sizes remain separate evaluations.

Result Provenance

- Format-aligned: 2026-09-16 UTC, 50 cases.
- Format-aligned / historical settings: 2026-09-26 UTC, 150 cases.
- Format-aligned / matched training prompt: 2026-09-26 UTC, 150 cases.
- Format-aligned: 2026-09-27 UTC, 30 cases.

Interpretation

On v1-50, success was 14/50 and clarification/refusal wording scores became nonzero. On the historical combined-150 evaluation, success was 42/150.

When tested with the recorded training prompt on combined-150, success was 40/150; template-shift success was 5/30. Alignment helped the engineering contract, but generalization remained weak.

Limits

The evaluations differ in suite, prompt and policy-era scoring; they are not repeated measurements of one fixed benchmark setup. Historical results do not fully pin selected training rows or base-model revision.

A format correction is necessary infrastructure, not proof that the decision policy has been learned robustly.

Supporting Files

The result links above are the surviving primary evidence. A separate immutable training record was not established for this historical experiment.

Notes assembled on 2026-10-10 from saved artifacts and repository records. No training, inference or result modification was performed to write this note.

PDF exported 2026-10-12. Original Markdown and benchmark evidence are preserved. Local artifact links require the project files.